Katharina Kolb

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Profile

Applied microeconomist with a strong command of causal inference and spatial data methods, specializing in the analysis of administrative, survey and grid datasets. Research interests in environmental, public, and migration economics as well as subjective indicators.

Education

Ph.D. in Economics *10/2022 - 12/2026*

Martin Luther University Halle-Wittenberg

- Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Christoph Wunder, Prof. Dr. Clemens Hetschko
- Expected defense: December 2026

M.Sc. in Economics *10/2017 - 01/2021*

Leipzig University

- Final grade: 1.4
- Including an exchange at Universidad de Chile (2019)

B.A. in International Business *10/2013 - 02/2017*

HTW Dresden

- Final grade: 1.2
- Including an exchange at Institute of Technology Tralee, Ireland (2015/16)

Academic Employment

Martin Luther University Halle-Wittenberg *10/2022 - today*

Research & teaching assistant, Chair of Econometrics

Research Institute Social Cohesion (FGZ) *06/2020 - 09/2022*

Researcher

Leipzig University *01/2020 - 09/2022*

Researcher, Institute of Public Finance and Public Management

Leipzig University *08/2018-07/2019*

Student assistant, Institute of Public Finance and Public Management

HTW Dresden *10/2014-01/2015*

Tutor

Research Stays

Deutsches Institut für Wirtschaftsforschung (DIW) *04/2026 - 06/2026*

Socio-Economic Panel (Visiting Program)

University of Leeds *10/2024 - 12/2024*

Department of Economics

Institute for Employment Research (IAB) Nürnberg *05/2024*

Migration and International Labour Studies (INTER)

Publication

Fernando, S.; Kolb, K., & Wunder, C. ”Rising Waters, Falling Well-Being: The Effects of the 2013 East German Flood on Subjective Well-Being”. Environmental and Resource Economics, accepted/forthcoming.

Working Papers

No Ripple in the Pond: Exposure to Refugees and Native Well-Being,
together with Kamal Kassam, R&R in Journal of Population Economics

From Heat to Strain? The Impact of Heatwaves on Subjective Well-Being,
together with Felix Zwies

Work in Progress

Extreme Heat and Educational Outcomes,
together with Alexander Moog

Presentations

Conference Presentations

07/2025 **ISQOLS Annual Conference,** Luxembourg (Luxembourg)
07/2025 **Royal Economic Society Annual Conference,** Birmingham (England)
06/2025 **38th Annual Conference of the European Society for Population Economics,** Naples (Italy)
07/2024 **15th International German Socio-Economic Panel User Conference,** Berlin (Germany)
06/2024 **6th International Conference on European Economics and Politics,** Zurich (Switzerland)
09/2023 **ISQLS Annual Conference,** Rotterdam (Netherlands)
09/2022 **41st DGS-Congress,** Bielefeld (Germany)

Seminars / Workshops

06/2026 **21st Workshop on Emp. Microeconomics / Applied Microeconometrics,** Leipzig (Germany)
04/2026 **Workshop on Natural Disasters and Labor Market Resilience,** Mainz (Germany)
03/2026 **AURÖ Workshop,** Leipzig (Germany)
06/2025 **SOEP Brownbag,** Berlin (Germany)
05/2025 **Doctoral Colloquium,** Leipzig (Germany)
04/2025 **Water Meeting UFZ,** Leipzig (Germany)
02/2025 **Bewell Meeting 2025,** Berlin (Germany)
12/2024 **Royal Economic Society PhD Conference 2024,** Portsmouth (UK)
11/2024 **Economic Research Seminar,** Leeds (UK)
09/2024 **Workshop on Causal Inference with Spatial Data,** Essen (Germany)
09/2024 **14th ifo Dresden Workshop on Regional Economics,** Dresden (Germany)
05/2024 **Workshop in Applied Economics for Young Researchers,** Hannover (Germany)
03/2024 **Bewell Meeting 2024,** Magdeburg (Germany)
02/2024 **CGDE Doctoral Workshop,** Dresden (Germany)
06/2023 **15th Workshop on Emp. Microeconomics / Applied Microeconometrics,** Halle (Germany)
07/2022 **FGZ Summerschool** Bremen (Germany)
01/2022 **FGZ Annual Conference Research Cluster 2,** Bremen (Germany)
10/2021 **14th Workshop on the Yearbook of Public Finance,** Leipzig (Germany)

Policy Talks

12/2022 **Elderly Study Programme Leipzig University,** Leipzig (Germany)
06/2022 **Presentation about value added analysis for the city of Leipzig,** Leipzig (Germany) / online
04/2022 **Final Workshop SUSIC,** Leipzig (Germany) / online

Fellowships & Awards

Womens' subsidies - Network Funds (MLU) *2023, 2024, 2025*
insitu award *2024, 2025*
Erasmus+ Staff Mobility Grant *2024*
Deutschlandstipendium *2014/15*

Academic Service & Other Activities

Environmental Economics Seminar Series, organizer *2026*
Appointment Committee (W3), member *2025/26*
WEM Halle, organizer of a PhD Workshop on Advances in Causal Inference *2025*
CGDE Program, co-organizer of a PhD course on Causal Machine Learning *2025*
Reading Group Labor Market Institutions, participant *Since 2024*
YES! Young Economic Solutions, supervisor of a school team *2022, 2023*

Teaching Experience

Econometrics II, Problem Class (Master) at MLU Halle *winter 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025*
Environmental Economics, Seminar (Master) at MLU Halle *summer 2026*
Introductory Econometrics, Problem Class (Bachelor) at MLU Halle *summer 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026*
Statistics I, Problem Class (Bachelor) at MLU Halle *summer 2023, 2024, 2026*
Statistics II, Problem Class (Bachelor) at MLU Halle *winter 2025*
State and Economy, Tutorial (Bachelor) at Leipzig University *summer 2019*
Theoretical Foundations, Tutorial (Bachelor) at HTW Dresden *winter 2014*

PhD Coursework

Introduction to Thermal Remote Sensing, NASA ARSET *06/2026*
Environmental Econometrics with Time Series & Spatial Data, M. Krause, B. Süßmuth *09/2025*
AI and research for doctoral students, Miriam Kant *09/2025*
Shift-Share IV, Peter Hull *07/2025*
Causal Machine Learning, Martin Huber *04/2025*
Codechella Madrid, Scott Cunningham, Kyle Butts *05/2024*
Quantitative Methods for Public Policy Evaluation, Albrecht Glitz *11/2023*
5th Summerschool in Advanced Economics, Jeffrey Wooldridge *07/2023*
Econometrics, CGDE *winter 2022*

Skills

Software **Stata, R, QGIS**
Editor **LaTeX**
Languages **German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), Italian (intermediate)**

Other Publications

Lorenz, A.; Pischtschan, L.; Kolb, K.; Hesse, M.; Lenk, T. (2024): Ungleichwertige Lebensverhältnisse als Bedrohung des gesellschaftlichen Zusammenhalts? Eine vergleichende Untersuchung von Interviews mit kommunalen Entscheidungsträger:innen und lokalen Gruppendiskussionen in Deutschland. In: Middell, M. (Hrsg.) Varianzen des Zusammenhalts. Historisch und transregional vergleichende Perspektiven. Frankfurt/New York: Campus. S. 337–364.

Lenk, T.; Bender, C.; Kolb, K.; Botta, F.; Starke, T. (2023): Räumliche Ausgleichsmechanismen im deutschen Föderalstaat. Sozialer Fortschritt. 72 (4). S. 369–396.

Springsklee, M.; Kolb, K.; Hesse, M.; Lenk, T. (2022): Regionalwirtschaftliche Wertschöpfungseffekte aus dem Betrieb von Photovoltaikanlagen innerhalb einer Kommune. In: Bruckner, T.; Johanning, S.; Kühne, S.; Scheller, F. (Hrsg.): Smart Utilities and Sustainable Infrastructure Change. Agentenbasierte Modellierung von urbanen Transformationsprozessen. S. 75–87

Lenk, T.; Hesse, M.; Kolb, K.; Goldammer, M. E. (2021): Gemeindefinanzbericht Sachsen 2020/21, Sachsenlandkurier. 30 (5)

Kolb, K. ; Hesse, M. (2021): Die Grundsteuerreform im deutschen Föderalstaat: Überblick zum aktuellen Stand in den Ländern und Beleuchtung vor dem Hintergrund des Gleichwertigkeitspostulats; In: Junkernheinrich, M.; Korioth, S.; Lenk, T.; Scheller, H.; Woisin, M. (Hrsg.); Jahrbuch für öffentliche Finanzen 2-2021. Berlin: Berliner Wissenschafts-Verlag. S. 281-297

Lorenz, A.; Lenk, T.; Hesse, M.; Kolb, K. (2020): Gesellschaftlicher Zusammenhalt und gleichwertige Lebensverhältnisse im bundesdeutschen Mehrebenensystem – Politische Weichenstellungen und Instrumente; In: Deitelhoff, N.; Groh-Samberg, O.; Middell, M. (Hrsg.), Gesellschaftlicher Zusammenhalt. Ein interdisziplinärer Dialog. Frankfurt am Main: Campus. 2020. S. 246-272